



Q1:

The poem is meant to encourage the setting off of journeys, accepting the future's uncertainties, and wishing safety for those who take journeys. The phrase "beyond the face of fear" alludes to the fact that the journey will be a difficult and fear-filled one, and that those who take it will need to overcome fears and obstacles to reach the end, making for a tense and obscure feeling for the audience. The phrase "kiss the wind then turn from it" expands on this, but advances the message and story of the poem, encouraging the journeymen to experience this fear and overall feeling as a necessary part of their travels without being overwhelmed by it. The use of "kiss" encapsulates the calm and relaxed way in which the poem can be read. The

final line “through this to that” avoids literally telling the reader of where the journey takes place and ends, allowing for a universal message and prioritizing the journey itself as opposed to its ending, giving readers the opportunity to picture what they think the journey is about and what it looks like imagery wise. The poem transitions from tense and uncertain to a more open-aired and resolute feeling to leave readers with courage and hope to make their own journey.

Q2:

One of the greatest challenges in expressing the poem’s meaning was deciding whether to encapsulate the mood of the entire poem or go word-by-word or phrase-by-phrase instead. What made this a hard decision was the fact that both creative directions work in their own ways in this situation. Capturing the entire mood makes for a more collective piece, while illustrating individual words and phrases potentially makes for better storytelling and emotional connection to audiences. However, focusing too heavily on individual words or phrases made for a more choppy and disconnected piece, whereas a single slow mood transition spanning the entire poem as one felt more fitting with the poem’s own transition from tension to bliss. By focusing on the poem as a whole, I felt that the meaning of the poem shined through the music better and in a more digestible manner. After coming to this conclusion, I decided to begin the melody with a D, the tonic of D major, which establishes a calm feeling that matches the feeling before a voyage is made. The melody climbs up to bar five, where it reaches its highest point before descending back by the eighth bar. This movement of the melody helped build on the poem’s emotional journey from uncertainty to openness and peace.

The second challenge was deciding how to go about encapsulating the tension of the poem’s early half. This was difficult to do because I did not want to give the piece a darker tone, especially with how little time there is to build on that before the poem transitions into a more calming feeling and eventually concludes altogether. The warmth that I intended for the piece would not have matched well with using a minor key, which led to me choosing D major due to its brighter feeling. In crafting the overall feel of the piece, I took inspiration from “Sun King” by The Beatles to bring the similar slow and dreamier atmosphere. This feeling felt right for this poem, giving it a gentle feel to accompany the blessing. To create tension without a dark tone, I used a rest in bar three to represent a time to take in the journey that is to come and give time to think about it for a short period of time before it begins. I chose $\frac{3}{4}$ meter to give the piece a gentle and swaying feeling, and bar five is used as the climax of the blessing through a B to a D before bar eight is used to bring a C-sharp to a D to conclude the blessing and piece.

Q3:

I believe my music choices worked well in reflecting the meaning of the poem. The slow melodic arc was effective in shaping the sense of the rising and falling of tension that the poem has and matches with the emotional feeling that the writer might have intended. The melody helps to move the lyrics from one to another and deliver the poem’s message without having too choppy or distinct of a feeling. The rest in bar three was effective in reflecting the poem as well,

creating more tension and time for thought provocation before transitioning into the later, more courage-centered part of the poem. My choice of D major kept the feeling warm and inviting while still allowing for a sense of instability in bars four and five, which is exactly what the poem's lyrics make readers feel as well. My choice to end the piece in bar eight with a C-sharp to D provided a natural movement and feeling of resolution that encapsulates the feeling of voyagers making a journey and reaching their destination.